



46-40 KYA PAINTINGS APPEAR ON CAVE WALLS

The earliest known representational art, dating from more than 45,500 years ago, was discovered on the walls of caves in Sulawesi, Indonesia. Although some non-figurative cave decoration predates this, it marks the beginning of a period of cave painting in various locations in Indonesia, France, and the Iberian peninsula. At the same time, the first representational sculptures appeared in Europe, carved in bone, ivory, and stone.

◀ A painting from Chauvet Cave in France

200 KYA Human migration from Africa into Europe and Asia begins

62 KYA The bow and arrow replaces the spear for hunting smaller game

10,000 BCE



18 KYA The craft of pottery develops in China

◀ The polar ice cap in the Last Glacial Period

113 KYA

100,000 YEAR ICE AGE BEGINS

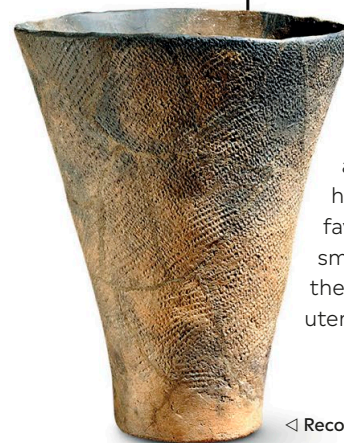
The climate change that had begun in about 200 KYA accelerated, marking the beginning of the Last Glacial Period, an ice age that lasted for over 100,000 years. As it intensified, the expanding ice sheet forced human populations southwards.

14-12 KYA

FIRST HUMAN SETTLEMENTS

The Last Glacial Period was followed by a rapid warming, bringing major environmental changes. Large animals adapted to the ice age, such as the

mammoth, died out, causing a shortage of big game for hunting. The new conditions forced a change in human behaviour: people largely abandoned the nomadic hunter-gatherer existence in favour of a settled lifestyle in small communities, prompting the development of domestic utensils such as pottery.



◀ Reconstruction of Jōmon pot, Japan